B2 - Written Mediation 2: Learning Sequence

A Music Festival

Your American friend, Kerry, is going to a festival in Spain in the summer. You went there the previous year and had a great time. You want to give Kerry some advice on the festival, for example, you know that there is a restaurant in the nearby village with good food at low prices, but there is no hotel there. You have also seen this poster about the festival.

Write an e-mail to your friend (about 150 words) giving him advice on accommodation, food, clothes and any other things you think would be helpful.



In written mediation, you need to refer to the document you have been asked to read. You cannot copy from it. Instead, paraphrase the ideas there in an informal way.

"QUICK TIPS"

Make sure you include all the aspects your friend needs to know in your e-mail. And do not forget the structure of an informal e-mail.

Let's get ready!

1. Analyse the task

Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

a) Who is the receiver of the message? _____

b) Why are you going to send him a message?
_____

c) What are you going to write? _____

2. Analyse the information

Read the information in the poster carefully.

a) Make a list of things you have to include in your e-mail.

b) Organise the ideas in a logical way. Write down the order. Use the chart below.

Things to include	Order

Let's prepare the language!

1. An informal e-mail

1. Read the following e-mail where a person is giving advice to a friend who wants to learn Spanish. Do not pay attention to the missing words. Pay attention to the following aspects and answer the given questions:

   a) What's the style, tone and register? _____

   b) Does the introduction set the tone and present the aim of the e-mail?
   _____

   c) Does the main paragraph include more than one piece of advice and are the structures used varied? _____

   d) How does the e-mail end? _____

Hi Sue,

Good to hear from you! I'm great, but I'm pretty busy at the moment because it's the end of the term and as you can imagine … I've got lots of exams! I'm really happy that you'd like to learn Spanish, so let me give you some advice.

I think the first thing you (1) ….. do is to look on the Internet for some free Spanish videos for beginners. You (2) ….. also look for free language activities. Getting a good dictionary – one with examples as well as meanings – is also (3) ….. . You need practice. So, if I were you, I (4) ….. write all the new words that you learn on flashcards that you could use to "test" yourself. If you have time to watch some films or series, watching them in Spanish, maybe with Spanish subtitles if you need them, (5) ….. your listening skills. Finally, (6) ….. listen to Spanish music? There are some great songs that you might like. Can you understand Rosalia? Well, you can try!

If you follow some of these tips, I'm sure your Spanish will improve a lot. Good luck!

Chris

2. Give advice and suggestions

1. Read the e-mail again and choose the correct answer.

1.	a) should	b) would	c) will
2.	a) could	b) try	c) have
3.	a) fun	b) great issue	c) a good idea
4.	a) will	b) should	c) would
5.	a) could	b) will help with	c) can need
6.	a) why don't you	b) what if	c) helps

Other Useful Language

What I would do is …
Why don't you …?
Have you tried …?
… will help with …
If I were you, I'd …
I'm not too sure about that.
Perhaps you could try …
How about …?

Do not use the same expressions all the time. It is important to vary the language to show you have a good vocabulary.



2. Complete these mini-dialogues by giving some advice.

a) Speaker 1: I can't cook. I follow the recipe but it's never great. I give up!
Speaker 2: Well, _____
Speaker 1: Hmm, that's actually a good idea.

b) Speaker 1: I need to buy a present for Julia, but I've no idea what she likes!
Speaker 2: _____ He might have some ideas.
Speaker 1: Perfect! Thanks.

c) Speaker 1: I can't sleep well, so I have no energy in the morning.
Speaker 2: _____
Speaker 1: Great, thanks. I'll try.

Let's mediate!

Your American friend, Kerry, is going to a festival in Spain in the summer. You went there the previous year and had a great time. You want to give Kerry some advice on the festival, for example, you know that there is a restaurant in the nearby village with good food at low prices, but there is no hotel there. You have also seen this poster about the festival.

Write an e-mail to your friend (about 150 words) giving him advice on accommodation, food, clothes and any other things you think would be helpful.

1. Content

Content

Look at the instructions and the poster and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend. You can use the following questions:

- Is it better to eat in the festival canteen or in the restaurant in the village? Why or why not?
- How does temperature affect your choices?
- Which tips will help your friend enjoy the festival?

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your language (register, style) to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.